

Context Profile: Janet

Last updated: 25 July 2026

Who I am

I'm Janet, a volunteer who enjoys helping people and organisations improve their processes and procedures so life runs a little more smoothly.

The organisation I support

I volunteer with **Beyond the Box Escape Rooms**, a small, family-run venue in Hastings, Hawke's Bay, New Zealand, owned and run by sisters **Joolz and Keren** (btbescaperooms.co.nz, 105 Market St North, Hastings).

Beyond the Box offers:

- Themed escape rooms (e.g. Sherlock, Gregg in the Box), \$35pp
- Virtual reality chairs — over 100 experiences, \$10–\$15 each, or venue hire for \$150/hour
- Mini escape games (25 minutes, \$20 per game)
- A games cafe with secondhand board games available to play and to purchase
- Occasional special events (e.g. Valentine's Day) to attract new customers

Hours: closed Sunday and Monday. Escape rooms run Tuesday–Friday from 3:30pm. Saturday has both shop hours (10am–2pm) and escape room hours (10:30am–7:30pm).

They rely predominantly on word of mouth rather than paid advertising, and have built a strong reputation for nearly all five-star reviews and high repeat business.

Who they serve

A mix of ages, from local Hawke's Bay families to visitors — young and old. The main constraint is concentration rather than age as such: younger children can struggle to stay engaged long enough to complete the puzzles, so the practical sweet spot is older kids through adults.

Mission and values

Beyond the Box exists to bring people together to laugh, collaborate, solve problems, and create memories — especially as a break from screens. Joolz and Keren describe it as putting their "heart and soul" into the business; it's a passion, not just a business to them.

This shows up as:

- **Personal touches** — birthday banners, custom puzzles for special occasions, and creative extras (e.g. a personalised "High Society Wedding" newspaper article woven into a game for a hen's party)
- **Genuine attentiveness** — chatting with customers before, during, and after their experience; watching engagement closely; taking feedback seriously and acting on it quickly (e.g. fixing incorrect hours on the website as soon as it was flagged)

- **Consistency through shared values** — as a small team, they train staff around care, attention to detail, and a sense of belonging, rather than rigid scripts
- **Community enrichment** — they see themselves as part of the local community, not just a transaction

Tone and voice

Friendly and polite, always. Both Joolz and Keren are genuinely open to trying different or alternative approaches, particularly where there's a clear advantage — they're not precious about "the way it's always been done."

My role there

I help mainly by sorting secondhand games to make sure all the pieces are accounted for, and I'm occasionally called on to be an extra adult on-site, since some of the staff are quite young.

How I'd like to work together (going forward)

I'm not a coder, so I'd like Claude to work with me the same careful way it works with Keren on her existing project (a custom app suite for venue management — staff scheduling, bookings, POS, and client communications):

- Never guess or hallucinate — ask me questions rather than assuming
- Go step by step, since I'm not technical
- Ask before making changes, and explain why
- Whatever we build should complement and merge seamlessly with the work Keren is already doing, not duplicate or conflict with it

What I want help with

Broader than just my day-to-day sorting tasks — I'd like this profile to support ongoing work helping Beyond the Box improve and grow. The first project in mind is a webpage where customers can browse the secondhand games collection, see descriptions and prices, and ideally purchase online — built to fit naturally alongside Keren's existing systems.